he received it graciously enough but since then I have heard nothing more of it, indeed I have only seen him once since then and only for a few minutes. I do not know whether this book will do me any good but I intend to try. William Cormick has succeeded pretty well, he has been appointed as he wished physician to the late Abbas Meerza's family at Tabreez, but they have not given him his father's pay as he expected. This was a thousand tomauns a year and they have only given William five hundred and one hundred for medicines this I think very fair considering he was just entering the service. We shall most likely be here about twenty days more as it takes some time arranging about how he is to be paid and getting the papers registered etc.

The Shah is now quite well but quite lame of one leg, from an issue which was put into the tendon Achilles by a quack French doctor who made a fortune of about eight or ten thousand pounds in fifteen months and went away with it. The two doctors who attended the Shah in his last illness have also been well paid, they have received from H: M: one thousand tomauns cash two shawls worth about two hundred more and the second class orders of the Lion and Sun each. And this is besides some handsome presents from the Kings mother and some other of his relations. Drs Bell and Cadi,[102] the two doctors above mentioned may have made near a thousand pounds each out of the job.

I have seen the prime minister several times and he has been civil to me which is more than I expected, whether I shall be able to get any thing done in my affairs is very uncertain, my creditors are most unreasonable and will not come to any terms. Col Sheil now the envoy will help me but I am afraid he will be able to do little for me.

I have scarcely been out of the town since I arrived having no horse here, indeed outside there is little to tempt one in the immediate neighbourhood. A dry flat stony plain without herbage and only here and there patches of cultivation. Not like Tabreez where for miles on every side there is a continuation of orchards and vineyards. At Tabreez too we are on much better terms with one another than the Europeans are here. The two Missions English and Russian are at opposite ends of the town and the intercourse of the members composing them is confined to a formal visit every now and then or a dinner nearly as formal. Very different is our little society at Tabreez. Some of the Greek merchants there though odd looking fellows and very queerly dressed, are men of most general information, and besides the dinners at the two consuls and other houses, M' d'Ozeroff keeps open house every Saturday night; and at his parties one meets Persians Russians Greeks and a mixture of all the nations to be found at Tabreez.

[102] Physicians of the British and Russian embassies, respectively.

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